

Executive Interview Summary with the owner of A9 Express

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Interviewee - A.Nirmalan (Owner of A9 express)

This report summarizes the requirement gathering session conducted with Mr. A. Nirmalan, Owner of A9 Express, to map out a centralized digital platform that transitions the business from manual workflows into an automated, real-time operation. Currently, A9 Express manages bookings manually through phone calls and WhatsApp, which causes delays, booking errors, and double bookings. To solve these problems, the new system will support bus ticket booking, airport transfers, and customized tour packages, featuring real-time seat availability and booking updates. The system will establish four clear user access levels: customers can make bookings, operators can manage schedules, drivers can view assigned trips, and admins can manage the entire system, including driver profiles, vehicle details, staff schedules, routes, and pricing.

From the customer's perspective, the booking process will be easy, collecting the customer's name, email address, phone number, and booking details so they can search routes, select seats, confirm bookings, and make payments via credit/debit cards, online banking, or mobile payment methods. Customers will be allowed to cancel or reschedule bookings within a specific time period according to company policies, and the system will automatically send booking confirmations, cancellation notices, and reminders through email or SMS. Additionally, the platform will feature branding tools to customize the company logo, name, contact details, and pricing, while providing admins with reports on bookings, revenue, vehicle usage, and popular routes to monitor business performance. Future improvements planned for later include mobile applications, GPS tracking, multilingual support, and loyalty programs.

Questions and Answers

01. What are the main problems you currently face in managing transport bookings?

We currently manage bookings manually through phone calls and WhatsApp, which causes delays, booking errors, and double bookings.

02. What services should the platform mainly support?

The platform should mainly support bus ticket booking, airport transfers, and customized tour packages.

03. Who are the primary users of the system and what access levels should they have?

Customers should be able to make bookings, operators should manage schedules, drivers should view assigned trips, and admins should manage the entire system.

04. What customer information should be collected during registration and booking?

The system should collect the customer's name, email address, phone number, and booking details.

05. How should the booking process work from the customer's perspective?

Customers should be able to search routes or services, select seats, confirm bookings, make payments, and receive notifications easily.

06. What payment methods would you like the system to support?

The system should support credit/debit cards, online banking, and mobile payment methods.

07. How should cancellations, refunds, and rescheduling be handled?

Customers should be allowed to cancel or reschedule bookings within a specific time period according to company policies.

08.What type of notifications should customers receive after bookings or cancellations?

Customers should receive booking confirmations, cancellation notices, and reminders through email or SMS.

09.How would you like routes, schedules, pricing, and seat availability to be managed?

Admins should be able to manage routes, schedules, and pricing, while the system automatically updates seat availability.

10.How should drivers, vehicles, and staff be managed within the system?

Admins should be able to add, update, and manage driver profiles, vehicle details, and staff schedules.

11.Do you require real-time seat availability and booking updates?

Yes, seat availability and booking status should update in real time.

12.What branding or customization features should be available for the business?

The system should allow customization of the company logo, company name, contact details, and pricing.

13.What future features or improvements would you like the platform to support later?

Future improvements may include mobile applications, GPS tracking, multilingual support, and loyalty programs.